

VOLTR

VOLTR PROGRAM

Hybrid

8 weeks · 3 strength sessions + 3 runs per week · full gym

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How this program works

THE PLAN

Eight weeks, three strength sessions of 50 to 65 minutes and three runs per week. Running volume rises steadily, and heavy leg work sits at least 48 hours before the quality run. Week 1 and week 8 both include a 3 km time trial and top sets on squat and bench, so you see whether you got stronger and faster together.

WHO IT IS FOR

Adults with at least a year of consistent lifting who can run 40 minutes easy without stopping and want strength and running to improve together.

WHO IT IS NOT FOR

Runners in the last 12 weeks before a marathon or ultra: race-specific running needs more volume.

Beginners in lifting or running.

Anyone with a current injury, or a medical condition that has not been cleared for hard training.

Weeks where six sessions will not fit: use the 3-Day Minimum plan.

EQUIPMENT

Full gym: barbell, rack, trap bar, dumbbells, cable station, landmine. A watch with a timer. A heart rate strap helps.

THE WEEK

Monday: Strength A (heavy legs)

Tuesday: Run 1, easy

Wednesday: Strength B (upper body)

Thursday: Run 2, quality

Friday: Strength C (full body, moderate legs)

Saturday: off

Sunday: Run 3, long

The days can move, the rules stay: heavy legs at least 48 hours before the quality run, moderate legs the day after it, at least 6 hours between a lift and a run on the same day. Only two runs possible: drop Run 1.

HOW TO READ THE SHEET

The spreadsheet has the tabs START HERE, BLOCK 1 (weeks 1 to 4), BLOCK 2 (weeks 5 to 8), LOG.

In the spreadsheet, rows are the three strength days and the three runs, column groups are the weeks. Each week has a target and an empty column for you: load in kg for lifts, total time and average effort for runs (52 min, effort 4).

3 × 5 @ RIR 2 means three sets of five, each ending two reps short of failure. /side means each arm or leg. 3a and 3b are a pair: one set of each, rest as listed on each line, repeat.

6 × 2 min @ effort 8, 2 min jog means six hard two-minute efforts with two minutes of easy jogging between.

Tempo: lowering, pause at the bottom, lifting, pause at the top, in seconds. X means as fast as possible.

RUNNING ZONES AND EFFORT

Running effort uses its own 1 to 10 scale. It is not the same as lifting RPE.

Zone 2 (Z2), easy: effort 3 to 4, full sentences, nose breathing most of the time. With a heart rate monitor, roughly 65 to 75 percent of max heart rate.

Age-based max heart rate formulas can be off by 10 beats or more, so effort comes first.

Tempo: effort 6 to 7, comfortably hard.

Intervals: effort 8, hard and even. The last rep as fast as the first.

Strides: 20 s fast and relaxed, then walk back.

Easy and long runs go by effort. Hills, heat and a hard week slow the pace at the same effort. Keep the effort.

RIR AND RPE

RIR means reps in reserve: how many more clean reps you could have done when you end the set. RPE is the same scale counted the other way: RPE 8 equals RIR 2, RPE 9 equals RIR 1.

Choose the load from the target RIR. Most people underestimate what was left by about one rep, more on higher-rep sets. If the last rep moved as fast as the first, add load next time.

PROGRESSION

Main lifts: add 2.5 kg (lower body) or 1 to 2.5 kg (bench) each week as long as last week's sets matched the target RIR. Accessories: double progression, add the smallest step once all sets reach the top of the rep range. RIR stays at 2 to 3 on most sets so the quality run stays quality.

Running: total time rises in weeks 1 to 3 and 5 to 7. The long run grows by about four minutes a week, with a shorter week 4, because sudden jumps in running volume are a common cause of overuse problems.

Week 4: deload for both. Week 1 and week 8: top sets Monday and Wednesday, 3 km time trial Thursday, heart rate test on the Tuesday run.

WARM-UP

Strength days, 8 minutes: 3 minutes bike or rower, 90/90 hip switch x 6 per side, world's greatest stretch x 4 per side, glute bridge x 10, band pull-apart x 15, then ramp-up sets on the first lift.

Quality run: 15 minutes easy including leg swings, A-skip 2 × 15 m and 4 strides.

Easy and long runs: the first 10 minutes slower than you want to go.

MISSED SESSIONS AND BAD WEEKS

Missed a strength session: do the next one in order, never two on one day.

Missed the quality run: skip it this week. Never turn the long run into a quality session.

Missed a full week: repeat the last complete week.

Bad day: sets, reps and run efforts stay as written, load and pace follow the effort. Log it.

Legs heavy for more than a week, sleep worse, resting heart rate up: run the week 4 structure once, then continue.

HOW TO LOG

Write the load in kg into the Load cell after the last working set. Different loads per set: 100, 102.5, 102.5. Reps short of the target: 100 × 5, 5, 4.

Fill in the LOG tab once a week, and the benchmarks in week 1 and week 8.

The log decides next week's load.

Block 1 · weeks 1 to 4 · base

Block 1 sets the baseline in week 1 (3 km time trial) and builds strength and running volume together. Lifting stays at RIR 2 to 3 so the runs keep their quality. Running time rises gradually from week to week. Week 4 is a deload for both: fewer sets, shorter runs, no hard intervals. Suggested week: Mon A, Tue Run 1, Wed B, Thu Run 2, Fri C, Sat off, Sun Run 3.

Day A · Heavy Legs + Pull

Monday. At least 48 hours before the quality run. About 60 minutes. Week 1: benchmark top set on the squat.

1 Back squat

Brace before you unrack. Sit down between the heels, knees over toes. Chest and hips rise together.

TEMPO 3-0-X-0 · REST 2-3 MIN

WK 1 · BASE

Top set 1 × 5 @ RIR 2
(benchmark), then 2 × 5 @
RIR 3

WK 2 · BUILD

3 × 5 @ RIR 2

WK 3 · BUILD

4 × 5 @ RIR 2

WK 4 · DELOAD

2 × 5 @ RIR 4

2 Romanian deadlift

Soft knees, hips back until the hamstrings stretch, bar close to the legs.

TEMPO 3-0-1-0 · REST 2 MIN

WK 1 · BASE

3 × 8 @ RIR 3

WK 2 · BUILD

3 × 8 @ RIR 2

WK 3 · BUILD

3 × 8 @ RIR 2

WK 4 · DELOAD

2 × 8 @ RIR 4

3a Chin-up

Full hang to chin over the bar. No swing. Add load once all sets reach 8 reps.

TEMPO 2-0-1-1 · REST 60 S

WK 1 · BASE

Set 1: max strict reps
(benchmark), then 2 × 5-8
@ RIR 3

WK 2 · BUILD

3 × 5-8 @ RIR 2

WK 3 · BUILD

4 × 5-8 @ RIR 2

WK 4 · DELOAD

2 × 5 @ RIR 4

3b Standing calf raise

Straight knee. Deep stretch at the bottom with a 2 s pause, then up onto the big toe.

TEMPO 2-2-1-1 · REST 90 S

WK 1 · BASE

3 × 10-15

WK 2 · BUILD

3 × 10-15

WK 3 · BUILD

3 × 10-15

WK 4 · DELOAD

2 × 10

4 Nordic hamstring curl

Heels anchored. Lower forward as slowly as you can, catch with the hands, push back up. Use a band for help if needed.

TEMPO SLOW LOWER · REST 90 S

WK 1 · BASE

2 × 4

WK 2 · BUILD

2 × 5

WK 3 · BUILD

3 × 5

WK 4 · DELOAD

1 × 4

Day B · Upper + Trunk

Wednesday. Day before the quality run, no heavy leg work. About 55 minutes.

1 Bench press

Shoulder blades together, feet planted. Touch the lower chest, pause 1 s, press.

TEMPO 2-1-X-0 · REST 2-3 MIN

WK 1 · BASE

Top set 1 × 5 @ RIR 2
(benchmark), then 3 × 6 @
RIR 3

WK 2 · BUILD

4 × 6 @ RIR 2

WK 3 · BUILD

4 × 6 @ RIR 2

WK 4 · DELOAD

2 × 6 @ RIR 4

2 One-arm DB row

Hand and knee on a bench, flat back. Row to the hip, pause, lower all the way.

TEMPO 2-0-1-1 · REST 90 S

WK 1 · BASE

4 × 8-10/side @ RIR 3

WK 2 · BUILD

4 × 8-10/side @ RIR 2

WK 3 · BUILD

4 × 8-10/side @ RIR 2

WK 4 · DELOAD

2 × 8/side @ RIR 4

3a Half-kneeling landmine press

Down on the knee of the pressing side. Squeeze that glute, press up and slightly forward.

TEMPO 2-0-1-0 · REST 60 S

WK 1 · BASE

3 × 8/side @ RIR 3

WK 2 · BUILD

3 × 8/side @ RIR 2

WK 3 · BUILD

3 × 8/side @ RIR 2

WK 4 · DELOAD

2 × 8/side @ RIR 4

3b Neutral-grip lat pulldown

Pull to the upper chest, elbows down and slightly back. Control the way up.

TEMPO 2-0-1-1 · REST 90 S

WK 1 · BASE

3 × 10-12 @ RIR 3

WK 2 · BUILD

3 × 10-12 @ RIR 2

WK 3 · BUILD

3 × 10-12 @ RIR 2

WK 4 · DELOAD

2 × 10 @ RIR 4

4a Side plank

Elbow under the shoulder, hips pushed forward. One line from head to feet.

TEMPO HOLD · REST 0 S

WK 1 · BASE

3 × 30 s/side

WK 2 · BUILD

3 × 30 s/side

WK 3 · BUILD

3 × 40 s/side

WK 4 · DELOAD

2 × 30 s/side

4b Cable face pull

Rope at eye height, elbows high, hands finish beside the ears.

TEMPO 2-0-1-1 · REST 60 S

WK 1 · BASE

3 × 12-15

WK 2 · BUILD

3 × 12-15

WK 3 · BUILD

3 × 12-15

WK 4 · DELOAD

2 × 12

Day C · Full Body

Friday. Day after the quality run, legs at moderate effort. About 60 minutes.

1 Trap bar deadlift

Moderate load, fast reps. Every rep moves at the same speed. End the set if one slows down.

TEMPO 2-0-X-0 · REST 2 MIN

WK 1 · BASE
3 × 4 @ RIR 3

WK 2 · BUILD
3 × 4 @ RIR 3

WK 3 · BUILD
4 × 4 @ RIR 3

WK 4 · DELOAD
2 × 4 @ RIR 4

2a Bulgarian split squat

Rear foot on a bench, DBs at your sides. Start with the weaker leg.

TEMPO 3-0-1-0 · REST 60 S

WK 1 · BASE
3 × 8/side @ RIR 3

WK 2 · BUILD
3 × 8/side @ RIR 2

WK 3 · BUILD
3 × 8/side @ RIR 2

WK 4 · DELOAD
2 × 8/side @ RIR 4

2b Incline DB press

Bench at 30 degrees, elbows about 45 degrees from the body.

TEMPO 3-0-1-0 · REST 90 S

WK 1 · BASE
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 3

WK 2 · BUILD
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 2

WK 3 · BUILD
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 2

WK 4 · DELOAD
2 × 8 @ RIR 4

3 Pallof press

Cable at chest height, side-on. Press out, hold 3 s, return. The torso does not turn.

TEMPO 3 S HOLD · REST 45 S

WK 1 · BASE
2 × 10/side

WK 2 · BUILD
3 × 10/side

WK 3 · BUILD
3 × 10/side

WK 4 · DELOAD
2 × 10/side

4 Farmer carry

Heaviest pair you can carry with good posture. Short, quick steps.

REST 60 S

WK 1 · BASE
3 × 40 m

WK 2 · BUILD
3 × 40 m

WK 3 · BUILD
4 × 40 m

WK 4 · DELOAD
2 × 30 m

5 Copenhagen plank, short lever

Knee on the bench, bottom leg free. Hips high.

TEMPO HOLD · REST 45 S

WK 1 · BASE
2 × 15 s/side

WK 2 · BUILD
2 × 20 s/side

WK 3 · BUILD
3 × 20 s/side

WK 4 · DELOAD
2 × 15 s/side

Runs · 3 Per Week

Log total time and average effort. Time trial: log the time.

R1 Easy run (Tuesday)

Zone 2, effort 3 to 4. Conversational the whole way. The run that goes first if the week only allows two.

TEMPO Z2

WK 1 · BASE

30 min Z2: first 20 min at your fixed test pace (heart rate benchmark)

WK 2 · BUILD

35 min Z2

WK 3 · BUILD

40 min Z2

WK 4 · DELOAD

25 min Z2

R2 Quality run (Thursday)

Warm-up 15 min easy including 4 strides. Cool-down 10 min easy. Recoveries are an easy jog.

TEMPO EFFORT 8

WK 1 · BASE

3 km time trial (benchmark)

WK 2 · BUILD

6 × 2 min @ effort 8, 2 min jog

WK 3 · BUILD

5 × 3 min @ effort 8, 2 min jog

WK 4 · DELOAD

20 min Z2 + 6 × 20 s strides

R3 Long run (Sunday)

Zone 2, effort 3 to 4. Same effort from start to finish. Bring water from 60 minutes.

TEMPO Z2

WK 1 · BASE

40 min Z2

WK 2 · BUILD

44 min Z2

WK 3 · BUILD

48 min Z2

WK 4 · DELOAD

35 min Z2

Block 2 · weeks 5 to 8 · build + test

Block 2 lowers the reps on the main lifts, adds load, and moves the quality run from short intervals to longer efforts. Running time keeps rising until week 7. Week 8 is the test: top sets Monday and Wednesday, 3 km time trial Thursday, reduced volume around them. Compare every benchmark with week 1 on the LOG tab.

Day A · Heavy Legs + Pull

Monday. Week 8: top sets today. About 60 minutes.

1 Back squat

Same setup as block 1. Heavier, fewer reps, same depth.

TEMPO 2-0-X-0 · REST 3 MIN

WK 5 · BUILD
3 × 4 @ RIR 2

WK 6 · BUILD
4 × 4 @ RIR 2

WK 7 · PEAK
4 × 3 @ RIR 2

WK 8 · TEST
Top set 1 × 3 @ RPE 9,
then 1 × 5 @ RIR 3

2 Romanian deadlift

Heavier than block 1, same strict position.

TEMPO 3-0-1-0 · REST 2 MIN

WK 5 · BUILD
3 × 6 @ RIR 2

WK 6 · BUILD
3 × 6 @ RIR 2

WK 7 · PEAK
3 × 6 @ RIR 2

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 6 @ RIR 3

3a Weighted chin-up

Belt or DB between the feet. Fewer than 5 strict reps: stay at bodyweight and add reps.

TEMPO 2-0-1-0 · REST 60 S

WK 5 · BUILD
3 × 4-6 @ RIR 2

WK 6 · BUILD
4 × 4-6 @ RIR 2

WK 7 · PEAK
4 × 4-6 @ RIR 2

WK 8 · TEST
Set 1: max strict reps at
bodyweight (benchmark),
then 1 × 4 @ RIR 3

3b Bent-knee calf raise

Seated calf machine, or a heavy DB on the knees. Full range, 2 s pause in the stretch. Trains the soleus.

TEMPO 2-2-1-1 · REST 90 S

WK 5 · BUILD
3 × 12-15

WK 6 · BUILD
3 × 12-15

WK 7 · PEAK
3 × 12-15

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 12

4 Nordic hamstring curl

Slower lowering than in block 1. Less band help if you used one.

TEMPO SLOW LOWER · REST 90 S

WK 5 · BUILD
3 × 5

WK 6 · BUILD
3 × 6

WK 7 · PEAK
3 × 6

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 4

Day B · Upper + Trunk

Wednesday, Week 8: bench top set today. About 55 minutes.

1 Bench press

Same setup as block 1. Pause on the chest on every rep.

TEMPO 2-1-X-0 · REST 3 MIN

WK 5 · BUILD
4 × 5 @ RIR 2

WK 6 · BUILD
4 × 5 @ RIR 2

WK 7 · PEAK
4 × 4 @ RIR 2

WK 8 · TEST
Top set 1 × 3 @ RPE 9,
then 2 × 5 @ RIR 3

2 Chest-supported DB row

Chest on an incline bench at 30 to 45 degrees. Elbows to the hips, pause at the top.

TEMPO 2-0-1-1 · REST 90 S

WK 5 · BUILD
4 × 8-10 @ RIR 2

WK 6 · BUILD
4 × 8-10 @ RIR 2

WK 7 · PEAK
4 × 8-10 @ RIR 2

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 8 @ RIR 3

3a Standing landmine press

Split stance, opposite leg forward. Press up and slightly forward, ribs stay down.

TEMPO 2-0-1-0 · REST 60 S

WK 5 · BUILD
3 × 6/side @ RIR 2

WK 6 · BUILD
3 × 6/side @ RIR 2

WK 7 · PEAK
3 × 6/side @ RIR 2

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 6/side @ RIR 3

3b Neutral-grip pull-up

Full hang to chin over the bar. Use a band if needed and keep the reps strict.

TEMPO 2-0-1-1 · REST 90 S

WK 5 · BUILD
3 × 6-10 @ RIR 2

WK 6 · BUILD
3 × 6-10 @ RIR 2

WK 7 · PEAK
3 × 6-10 @ RIR 2

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 6 @ RIR 3

4a Suitcase carry

One heavy DB in one hand. Walk tall, shoulders level.

REST 0 S

WK 5 · BUILD
3 × 30 m/side

WK 6 · BUILD
3 × 30 m/side

WK 7 · PEAK
3 × 30 m/side

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 30 m/side

4b Cable face pull

Rope at eye height, elbows high.

TEMPO 2-0-1-1 · REST 60 S

WK 5 · BUILD
3 × 12-15

WK 6 · BUILD
3 × 12-15

WK 7 · PEAK
3 × 12-15

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 12

Day C · Full Body

Friday. Week 8: the day after the time trial, keep it light. About 60 minutes.

1 Trap bar deadlift

Moderate to heavy, fast reps. End the set if a rep slows down.

TEMPO 2-0-X-0 · REST 2 MIN

WK 5 · BUILD
3 × 3 @ RIR 3

WK 6 · BUILD
4 × 3 @ RIR 3

WK 7 · PEAK
4 × 3 @ RIR 2

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 3 @ RIR 4

2a DB reverse lunge

DBs at your sides. Long step back, knee lightly to the floor, drive up through the front foot.

TEMPO 2-0-1-0 · REST 60 S

WK 5 · BUILD
3 × 8/side @ RIR 2

WK 6 · BUILD
3 × 8/side @ RIR 2

WK 7 · PEAK
3 × 8/side @ RIR 2

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 6/side @ RIR 3

2b Weighted push-up

Plate on the upper back or a band across it. Chest to a fist-height target.

TEMPO 2-0-1-0 · REST 90 S

WK 5 · BUILD
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 2

WK 6 · BUILD
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 2

WK 7 · PEAK
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 2

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 8 @ RIR 3

3 Half-kneeling cable lift

Cable low on the side of the down knee. Pull up and across, hips stay square.

TEMPO CONTROLLED · REST 45 S

WK 5 · BUILD
3 × 8/side

WK 6 · BUILD
3 × 8/side

WK 7 · PEAK
3 × 10/side

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 8/side

4 Farmer carry

Heavier than block 1, shorter distance.

REST 60 S

WK 5 · BUILD
3 × 30 m

WK 6 · BUILD
3 × 30 m

WK 7 · PEAK
4 × 30 m

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 30 m

5 Copenhagen plank, short lever

Same as block 1, longer holds.

TEMPO HOLD · REST 45 S

WK 5 · BUILD
3 × 20 s/side

WK 6 · BUILD
3 × 25 s/side

WK 7 · PEAK
3 × 25 s/side

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 15 s/side

Runs · 3 Per Week

Log total time and average effort. Time trial: log the time and compare with week 1.

R1 Easy run (Tuesday)

Zone 2, effort 3 to 4. Strides in week 7: 20 s fast and relaxed, walk back.

TEMPO Z2

WK 5 · BUILD 40 min Z2	WK 6 · BUILD 45 min Z2	WK 7 · PEAK 45 min Z2 + 4 × 20 s strides	WK 8 · TEST 30 min Z2: first 20 min at the week-1 test pace (heart rate benchmark)
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R2 Quality run (Thursday)

Warm-up 15 min easy including 4 strides. Cool-down 10 min easy. Week 8: same warm-up as week 1, then the time trial.

TEMPO EFFORT 6-8

WK 5 · BUILD 3 × 8 min @ effort 6-7 (tempo), 2 min jog	WK 6 · BUILD 4 × 4 min @ effort 8, 2 min jog	WK 7 · PEAK 5 × 4 min @ effort 8, 2 min jog	WK 8 · TEST 3 km time trial (benchmark)
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R3 Long run (Sunday)

Zone 2, effort 3 to 4. Same effort start to finish. Water and some carbohydrate from 60 minutes.

TEMPO Z2

WK 5 · BUILD 52 min Z2	WK 6 · BUILD 56 min Z2	WK 7 · PEAK 60 min Z2	WK 8 · TEST 40 min Z2
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V O L T R

NEXT STEP

Want it built around your weeks?

This program is written for most weeks. 1:1 coaching builds your training around your schedule, travel and history, and adjusts it every week.

Book a free 30-minute call: voltr.at/#book